

CLA Brand & Design Language OS v1

Chapter 1 – Brand Philosophy (Draft)

Purpose

This document defines the visual philosophy that will guide every future design decision for the CLA website. It defines how CLA should look, feel, and be experienced.

1. Apple-Level Craftsmanship

CLA should feel like Apple in craftsmanship, precision, consistency, and quality—not by copying Apple's appearance, but by adopting its standard of excellence.

2. Exceptional First Impression

Visitors should immediately recognize the website as one of the most beautiful church websites they have ever seen. Beauty comes through intentional craftsmanship, timeless design, and disciplined consistency.

3. Meticulous Execution

Every page, image, interaction, and detail should feel intentionally designed. Navigation must be effortless, mobile-first, and accessible.

4. Disciplined Excellence

The website should point people toward Jesus through elegant, refined design. Avoid clutter, competing color palettes, emojis, gimmicks, or inconsistent styles.

5. Timeless Identity

Simplicity keeps the website modern. Build a recognizable identity through strong typography, premium craftsmanship, consistent rounded corners, and a restrained visual language. Explore royal blue as the primary brand direction with gold as a thoughtful accent.

6. One Brand, Many Experiences

Every page should be unmistakably CLA while expressing its own personality. Different ministries may have unique atmospheres without becoming separate brands.

Living Website Philosophy (Draft)

The website should evolve continuously through seasonal photography, thoughtful refinements, updated content, and ongoing craftsmanship so it remains timeless without requiring complete redesigns.